

Home safety guide with fall prevention checklists, emergency response plans, and assistive device recommendations for aging-in-place families — Action Checklist

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BATHROOM TRANSFER ASSESSMENT

- ☐ **Observe how your parent stands from the toilet seat and note whether they push off on sinks, counters, or towel bars instead of proper support surfaces because surfaces not designed for body weight can give way during transfers.:** Observe how your parent stands from the toilet seat and note whether they push off on sinks, counters, or towel bars instead of proper support surfaces because surfaces not designed for body weight can give way during transfers.
- ☐ **Watch your parent enter and exit the shower to determine if stepping over the tub wall creates a balance-threatening moment that puts them at high risk for hip fractures.:** Watch your parent enter and exit the shower to determine if stepping over the tub wall creates a balance-threatening moment that puts them at high risk for hip fractures.
- ☐ **Assess whether a nightstand or table next to the toilet is being used as an unofficial armrest for support when sitting or standing, which indicates they need a properly installed grab bar in that location.:** Assess whether a nightstand or table next to the toilet is being used as an unofficial armrest for support when sitting or standing, which indicates they need a properly installed grab bar in that location.
- ☐ **Test every towel bar in the bathroom by pulling on it firmly to determine if it is anchored securely enough to support body weight because standard towel bars mounted in drywall can pull out under 50 to 80 pounds of force.:** Test every towel bar in the bathroom by pulling on it firmly to determine if it is anchored securely enough to support body weight because standard towel bars mounted in drywall can pull out under 50 to 80 pounds of force.

GRAB BAR INSTALLATION PRIORITIES

- ☐ **Install a horizontal grab bar on the wall behind the toilet so your parent has something solid to grip while lowering onto or rising from the seat, which is often the harder direction for older adults.:** Install a horizontal grab bar on the

wall behind the toilet so your parent has something solid to grip while lowering onto or rising from the seat, which is often the harder direction for older adults.

- ❑ **Mount a vertical grab bar on the outside of the shower entrance where your parent steps over the threshold and most commonly loses their balance during the high-risk entry and exit movement.:** Mount a vertical grab bar on the outside of the shower entrance where your parent steps over the threshold and most commonly loses their balance during the high-risk entry and exit movement.
 - ❑ **Place a grab bar inside the shower on the wall your parent faces when standing under the water spray rather than on the back or side walls because hands naturally reach forward for support.:** Place a grab bar inside the shower on the wall your parent faces when standing under the water spray rather than on the back or side walls because hands naturally reach forward for support.
 - ❑ **Replace all bathroom towel bars with grab bars rated for 250 to 500 pounds that are screwed directly into wall studs for secure mounting instead of relying on small screws in drywall that cannot support body weight.:** Replace all bathroom towel bars with grab bars rated for 250 to 500 pounds that are screwed directly into wall studs for secure mounting instead of relying on small screws in drywall that cannot support body weight.
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MONITORING AND RESPONSE PLANNING

- ❑ **Establish a daily check-in system with your parent so someone knows within 22 seconds if a fall has occurred and your parent cannot get up because lying on the floor for hours triggers serious health complications.:** Establish a daily check-in system with your parent so someone knows within 22 seconds if a fall has occurred and your parent cannot get up because lying on the floor for hours triggers serious health complications.
 - ❑ **Create a written emergency response plan your parent can follow if they fall while alone, including clear instructions for calling for help and what to do while waiting for assistance to arrive.:** Create a written emergency response plan your parent can follow if they fall while alone, including clear instructions for calling for help and what to do while waiting for assistance to arrive.
 - ❑ **Install a medical alert device or place a phone within arm's reach of the toilet and shower so your parent can call for help immediately if a fall occurs while they are alone and unable to get up on their own.:** Install a medical alert device or place a phone within arm's reach of the toilet and shower so your parent can call for help immediately if a fall occurs while they are alone and unable to get up on their own.
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- ☐ **Document all identified fall hazards in your parent's home and share the list with family members and caregivers who visit regularly so they understand which areas require extra vigilance and assistance.:** Document all identified fall hazards in your parent's home and share the list with family members and caregivers who visit regularly so they understand which areas require extra vigilance and assistance.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.